Project Reflection – Project 01 – Citizen Data Dashboard Redesign

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1. Design Process

How did your research activities inform your design process?

For the research I was a bit confused in the starting like how to carry out the research for something which is pre-existing. Do we need to have a persona for it or not and like how to carry out the precedent research but eventually with help through Gill and like the research methodologies we had, we created a user persona of how a person that we want would be using and then it became smooth to carry out research like finding out similar indicators around North America, how is the structure, which to find out whether a competitor has any review from the users like they like it or not and this is how I carried the precedent research including the competitive analysis and creating user persona.

How did sketching and wireframing shape your design process?

As I said, it was a pre-existing project, so it was a bit confusing for me as to where to start, but then doing activities like Crazy 8 and me and Shah did a lot of wireframing and sketching and reviewing each and every component of the design. It eventually shaped a clean, minimal sketch, which helped us in further creating a lo-fi prototype. The wireframe and sketches helped me a lot. They helped me to decide that which information is more important and which information needed more focus that was to be shared on the indicator page.

How did exploring data visualization JavaScript libraries influence your design decisions?

While I was exploring visualization in JavaScript libraries, I was pretty confused where to place the map and where would the selectors go, but eventually using the leaflet JavaScript query and chart.js and all the other libraries we had, I came up with a clear output using the code and according to that output, I designed my map section. From this exploration, I learned that the structure should be in a way that when it calls the data and multiple kind of details load on that area, it still looks good and that was the thing I learned from this exploration.

Looking back, do you feel you sought feedback at the right moments?

Looking back, I find that we should have gotten more reviews from our classmates or Gill's, even while doing the wireframe. The most important time for me to have taken feedback was when once my lo-fi was under process because I was still confused like what information to include in a lo-fi and what not, should headings be used or not, and eventually it was a pretty big confusion. I had three designs for wireframe and I sent all those three to Gill and it was not a good practice and I came to know it about once I have submitted, so I think it would have been a good time if I would have reached him during that process instead of after finishing that process.

What specific aspect of this project was most valuable for your learning?

The specific aspect of this project for me was to prototype the Hi-Fi design. A bit challenging for me was to create the bar charts in Figma for prototyping so they show and change state once something is selected in the prototype. Well for this I was pretty confused in the beginning but then I saw a lot of Figma tutorials and also got feedback from my project partner. And also got some reviews from Gill and we also did a design expo in the class which helped me a lot to further make the design better.

2. Individual Role in the Group Project

What specific strengths or skills did you bring to the project?

As far as I think, I'm more on the design side of the stuff. I do have a bit of developer and developing experience, but I think the skills I have for design are pretty much good. For example, we, both the partners, did our own Crazy 8. We came up with the final wireframe. We designed it together, but then from then onwards, most of the designing was handled by me, and the documentation was handled by Char. And it was a good balance between both. Like, I am stronger in the design. That doesn't mean that Char didn't help with the design. We both had the equal part in it. But yeah, I handled more technical things in design. Which I think is my strength.

What would you do differently to contribute more effectively to the group?

As a group, I think I wouldn't have to change anything or to do differently. Me and Char were pretty good while doing this project. For example, we had clear communication throughout the project. Even when we were at home, we were doing something regarding the project. We updated each other through Discord, updated each other about any deadlines, submissions, and if we found something new. Also helped creating designs and finalizing the library, seeing that the code would work in future or not. So yeah, it was pretty good experience working together. And as far as I think for me, I wouldn't have changed anything as it was very effective and efficient.

3. Roles of Partners in the Group Project

What specific strengths or skills did your partner bring to the project?

Char is very effective and efficient when it comes to handling deadlines and as well as maintaining the communication and managing the work. She was very skilled in dividing tasks so that we can accomplish one task at a time on our own and then it all together caters the final goal which we have as a group towards the project.

Reflect on how you divided responsibilities.

Yeah, the division was pretty much effective. I handled most of the technical thing and the creative things, while Char effectively and efficiently handled task division, maintaining a Jira board for the project, updating everything through all the clear communication means. We even communicated through Discord, emails, and maintained proper documentation of each and everything. Char maintained all the written and research data in Figma files, documents, and clearly communicated everything with Joanna as well, related to the project we had with her, which is in alignment with Gill's project.

What challenges arose in your collaboration?

I don't think there was any challenge which emerged while this collaboration.

What will you do differently in your next group project?

Well in next project, I would for sure keep in mind to get early reviews of the work I am doing from the professor as well as like Keeping it clear in mind that how to carry out a research if we are getting any project which is pre-existing and we don't have to create it from scratch and And I would surely learn the skill of communication and task management from Char.